

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 1, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 34:1-10

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel, prophesy and say to them, 'Thus says the Lord God to the shepherds: "Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Should not the shepherds feed the flocks?"

3 "You eat the fat and clothe yourselves with the wool; you slaughter the fatlings, but you do not feed the flock."

4 "The weak you have not strengthened, nor have you healed those who were sick, nor bound up the broken, nor brought back what was driven away, nor sought what was lost; but with force and cruelty you have ruled them."

5 "So they were scattered because there was no shepherd; and they became food for all the beasts of the field when they were scattered."

6 "My sheep wandered through all the mountains, and on every high hill; yes, My flock was scattered over the whole face of the earth, and no one was seeking or searching for them."

7 "'Therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of the Lord:"

8 "'As I live,' says the Lord God, 'surely because My flock became a prey, and My flock became food for every beast of the field, because there was no shepherd, nor did My shepherds search for My flock, but the shepherds fed themselves and did not feed My flock'—"

9 "therefore, O shepherds, hear the word of the Lord!"

10 "Thus says the Lord God: 'Behold, I am against the shepherds, and I will require My flock at their hand; I will cause them to cease feeding the sheep, and the shepherds shall feed themselves no more; for I will deliver My flock from their mouths, that they may no longer be food for them.'"

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to speak against the shepherds (leaders) of Israel, because they fed themselves instead of feeding the flock.
 - The passage lists what the shepherds failed to do: they did not strengthen the weak, heal the sick, bind up the injured, or bring back the lost sheep — instead they ruled with force.
 - Because there was no shepherd to watch over them, the flock scattered and became food for wild animals; the Lord declares He will be against these shepherds and hold them accountable.
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III. Passage Analysis

Caring isn't a slogan — it's a specific action

Godly shepherds must serve more for the benefit of the flock than their own benefit.
[1]

The passage lists five things a shepherd should do — strengthen, heal, bind up, bring back, seek out — and every one of them is a concrete action, not just words. Really caring about someone isn't saying "I care about you"; it's noticing where they're struggling and actually doing something about it.

God sees everything — He doesn't pretend not to notice

Shepherds are given a position of glory and honor, but when they fail to fulfill their duty, God's wrath falls upon them. [2]

Having a position and having influence also comes with responsibility. God doesn't let leaders off the hook just because of their status — whoever you choose to care for, or choose to ignore, God sees it clearly.

IV. Reflection Question

When you notice someone in your friend group or class being left out or excluded, do you usually step in, or just look out for yourself?

Ezekiel 34 says God sees the shepherds who only look after themselves and ignore the weak, and He also sees every sheep that gets overlooked.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik commentary on Ezekiel 34,

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-34/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, Bible Knowledge Commentary (聖經精讀本),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT34.htm>